

Request for Information (RFI)

**Air Force Technical Applications Center (AFTAC)
Key Management Solutions (KMS)**

25 February 2026

1. Request for Information (RFI)

AFTAC RFI for a centralized Key Management System.

2. Purpose

THIS IS A REQUEST FOR INFORMATION ONLY. Issuance of this RFI does not constitute a commitment to issue a follow-on request for proposals (RFP), contract award, or to pay any costs incurred by vendors in preparing responses to this RFI.

This RFI invites vendors to provide detailed information regarding a centralized Key Management System (KMS) to enhance security and resilience of AFTAC mission systems principally located at Patrick Space Force Base, Florida. The core KMS must support both a primary and alternate site in a high-availability, active-active architecture to ensure secure, continuous operations. The objective is to obtain information on potential solutions to enable AFTAC to simplify, standardize, and secure key management across its enterprise.

Information received in response to this RFI will assist AFTAC in determining KMS requirements and scope of work. Submitting a response to this RFI is not a guarantee in any way that a vendor will be selected for any subsequent RFP, nor does it preclude any vendor from responding to future procurement opportunities. No contract will result from any response to this RFI.

2.1 Responses

Interested parties should respond to this RFI with an explanation of the solution(s) and capabilities, including available license models, systems and implementation, and renewal and sustainment costs. Responses should NOT be limited to simple affirmations (e.g., 'yes we can do this').

Respondents should provide diagram(s) illustrating the implementation and offering insight into the knowledge and technologies that differentiate their solution.

In addition to direct responses to this request, interested parties may also submit a white paper through AFTAC Commercial Solutions Opening (CSO) 2024 under Notice ID FA702224SC001 posted on sam.gov. Explicit instructions for responding via the CSO are posted on the offering page, and responses that do not follow these instructions may not be considered.

Questions related to this RFI must be asked through the Q&A process available on the posting site (e.g., NASA SEWP, GSA 2GIT, etc.). Questions received verbally or via email will not be accepted nor answered.

Proprietary information, if any, should be minimized and **MUST BE CLEARLY MARKED**. All submissions become Government property and will not be returned.

THIS IS A REQUEST FOR INFORMATION ONLY. This RFI is issued solely for information and planning purposes and does not constitute a commitment to issue an invitation for bids, request for proposals (RFP), or a contract award. Any information received in response to this RFI will assist AFTAC in finalizing scope of work and requirements which may be used in a future RFP. Submitting a response to this RFI does not guarantee a vendor will be selected for any subsequent RFP, nor does it preclude any vendor from responding to future procurement opportunities. The Government will not pay for any costs incurred by a vendor in preparing a

response to this RFI.

3. Technical Requirements

The contractor shall ensure that all applicable Commercial-Off-The-Shelf (COTS) Information Assurance (IA) and IA-enabled products comply with [AFI 17-130, Cybersecurity Program Management](#). All Information Technology (IT) hardware, firmware, and software components or products incorporated into Department of Defense Information Networks (DoDIN) must comply with evaluation and validation requirements in [DoDI 8500.01](#). Furthermore, all systems and components must adhere to the Risk Management Framework (RMF) as outlined in [DoDI 8510.01](#) and must be configured and maintained in accordance with applicable Security Technical Implementation Guides ([STIGs](#)). The contractor shall also participate in the DoD Information Assurance Vulnerability Management (IAVM) program, promptly addressing security patches and vulnerabilities. Applicable [NIST](#) Special Publications, including [NIST SP 800-53](#) and, if applicable, [NIST SP 800-171](#), must be adhered to. If any systems interact with cloud environments, the [DoD Cloud Computing Security Requirements Guide \(SRG\)](#) must be followed. All personnel must meet the requirements of [DoD Instruction 5200.02](#), Personnel Security Program (PSP). Finally, the contractor must demonstrate adherence to Supply Chain Risk Management (SCRM) best practices.

3.1 KMS Core Requirements

As part of ongoing Zero Trust initiatives, AFTAC requires a consolidated KMS.

3.1.1 General System Requirements

- The solution shall integrate into standard Identity Credential & Access Management (ICAM) solutions, including Windows Active Directory (AD) and other commercial identity brokers.
- The solution shall be a centralized, API-driven Key Management System. The system must provide, at a minimum: full lifecycle management for secrets (e.g., keys, certificates, API tokens), secure authentication and authorization for non-person entities (applications, services, and systems), and comprehensive auditing of all API operations and secrets access to an existing Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) system.
- Secure DNS and NTP shall be presumed to be available.

3.1.2 User Interfaces

The solution shall provide dual interfaces for system administration: a Graphical User Interface (GUI) and a Command Line Interface (CLI).

- **Graphical User Interface (GUI):** A secure, web-based GUI for routine operations that is intuitive for administrators familiar with common directory management paradigms (e.g., Active Directory) and includes integrated, context-sensitive help.
- **Command Line Interface (CLI):** A feature-complete CLI where all administrative functions are accessible. The CLI shall provide comprehensive, integrated help (e.g.,

via a --help flag) and be fully scriptable and compatible with BASH and PowerShell, utilizing standard input, output, and exit code conventions.

3.1.3 Client Integration & Protocol Support

The solution shall provide secrets and credentials to a wide variety of clients and endpoints by supporting the following standard, industry-recognized protocols at a minimum:

- **Operating System Authentication:** LDAP/LDAPS, Kerberos, SSH (Certificate-based).
- **Database Credential Management:** TDS (for Microsoft SQL Server), OCI (for Oracle), and native PostgreSQL connection protocols.
- **Application & Web Server Integration:** REST/HTTPS (for API access), OIDC (for application identity).
- **Storage System Integration:** REST/HTTPS (for modern storage APIs), SSH (for legacy CLI management).

3.1.4 Identity & Authentication Integration

The solution shall integrate with authoritative identity sources and support established authentication protocols, including:

- **Identity Provider Federation:** OIDC and SAML 2.0.
- **Directory Integration:** LDAP / LDAPS.
- **Legacy Authentication:** RADIUS, TACACS+.
- **Single Sign-On:** Kerberos protocol.

3.2 CLIN 0001: Production and Continuity KMS

This CLIN shall deliver the core KMS, implemented as a bi-directionally mirrored solution spanning a Production Environment and a Continuity Environment.

- 3.2.1 **Availability:** The system shall be designed for 99.99% uptime. The contractor shall state the guaranteed Recovery Point Objective (RPO) and Recovery Time Objective (RTO) for an automated failover to the Continuity Environment.
- 3.2.2 **Maintenance:** The system shall support non-interference patch management. The contractor shall describe the process for applying and rolling back patches with zero operational downtime for authentication and secrets-retrieval services.
- 3.2.3 **Scalability:** The solution must be scalable to support thousands of users and devices.

3.3 CLIN 0002: Research, Development, Test & Evaluation (RDT&E)

This CLIN shall deliver a non-redundant implementation for an RDT&E network. This system shall replicate the Production system capability while being completely separate and independent. It must be scalable to support a thousand users and devices across a single site.

3.4 General Technical Requirements

- 3.4.1 Governing Security Posture:** The system shall be architected in alignment with Department of Defense (DoD) Zero Trust and data-centric security principles, satisfying the security controls and capabilities outlined in the DoD Zero Trust Strategy and applicable DISA STIGs.
- 3.4.2 Deliverable Documentation:** The contractor shall provide a business overview diagram of the proposed system configuration and a letter of volatility that identifies all components containing memory and provides instructions on how to purge or remove them per DoD specifications.
- 3.4.3 System Monitoring:** The system shall autonomously monitor and log system utilization and provide utilities to document and report on the utilization of all sub-components, including clear guidance on system bottlenecks and recommended corrective actions.
- 3.4.4 Software-Defined Architecture and Repeatability:** The system shall be presumed to be virtualized. For solutions delivered primarily as software, vendors shall describe how their architecture supports automated, repeatable deployments through an Infrastructure as Code (IaC) approach. The response should detail the minimum virtual hardware footprint (vCPU, RAM, storage) and outline how the proposed IaC methodology would enable rapid provisioning and system recovery. If physical hardware is required, its specifications (RU, power, BTU) must be clearly detailed.

3.5 Common Criteria Evaluation & Validation Scheme Mandate

The contractor shall ensure that products used to protect information on [National Security Systems](#) are certified by the [NIAP/CCEVS approved product list](#).

4. Ordering Table

CLIN 0001: Production and Continuity KMS. One (1) complete, bi-directionally mirrored Key Management Solution, spanning a Production Environment and a Continuity Environment, as specified in section 3.2. Includes all necessary hardware, software, licenses, installation, training, and support.

CLIN 0002: Research, Development, Test & Evaluation (RDT&E) KMS. One (1) complete, non-redundant Key Management Solution for the RT&DE environment, as specified in section 3.3. Includes all necessary hardware, software, licenses, installation, training, and support

Optional CLINs: Air-Gapped Network Instances. Option to procure up to six (6) additional self-contained, air-gapped instances of the system described in CLIN 0001. Each instance to be priced separately

5. Technical Contractual Requirements

5.1 Technical Refresh

To ensure new design enhancements and technological updates or advances, the contractor shall offer, under this Delivery Order (DO), hardware and software components available to the contractor's commercial customers. Furthermore, the contractor shall make available any commercially available updates to the hardware and software provided under this DO. If such updates are available to other customers without charge, then they shall also be made available to the Government without additional charge. The contractor will ship these updates to existing customers who have acquired the hardware/software being updated under this DO. Vendor commercial product offerings shall include "state of the art" technology, i.e., the most current proven level of development available in each product category.

5.2 Trade Agreement Act (TAA)

All proposed products must be compliant with the Trade Agreements Act of 1979 (TAA) and related clauses in Section I of this contract. In accordance with [DFARS 252.225-7021](#), the Trade Agreements Certificate at [DFARS 252.225-7020](#) shall be provided for each end item defined and specified in a solicitation that exceeds the TAA threshold subject to the waivers and exceptions provided in [FAR 25.4](#), and [DFARS 225.4](#) offered in response to any RFQ issued under this contract. Please note that Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) paragraph 25.103(e) includes an exemption from the Buy American Act (BAA) for acquisition of information technology that is commercial items.

5.3 Authorized Resellers

The contractor may be an authorized reseller of new and refurbished/remanufactured original equipment manufacturer (OEM) equipment proposed under this DO. The contractor may also procure directly from OEMs or utilize other legitimate distribution channels to provide the required products in accordance with the OEM's policies on reselling. Any contractor channel relationships with OEM partners (gold, silver, etc.) will be represented in the best pricing offered. If the contractor is not an OEM reseller, the contractor shall clearly identify this in the submitted proposal and list the OEM resell partner's registered relationship with the OEM. DOs may restrict the use of authorized resellers, specific OEMs, or identify required OEMs. The contractor shall ensure all products are genuine and eligible for any OEM warranties, maintenance agreements and licensing as offered. Genuine products are those products the OEM, by their policy, considers not "secondary", destroyed, stolen or scrapped.

5.4 Remanufactured/Refurbished Products

Any remanufactured or refurbished product offering shall be clearly identified as such by the contractor in the submitted proposal. Remanufactured and/or refurbished products shall be certified according to the standards set forth in the OEM's policy. OEM or factory certification shall be provided for remanufactured products.

5.5 Items on Backorder

In their response to a Request for Quote (RFQ), the contractor shall provide notification, if applicable, that a particular item is on back order, the expected lead-time to fulfill the order, etc. It shall be implicit that a response to an RFQ with no items identified on backorder is a declaration that the items are available at the time of quote submission.

5.6 Warranty

The contractor shall provide any OEM pass-through warranty and standard commercial

warranties applicable to the products being purchased at no cost. This shall apply to new, refurbished and remanufactured equipment.

5.7 Hardware and Associated Software and Peripherals

All hardware delivered under this DO shall include associated software, documentation and associated peripherals required for operations (such as controllers, connectors, cables, drivers, adapters, etc.) as provided by the OEM. This is true only if the applicable OEM provides such items with the product itself.

5.8 Software

For all software that is outside of hardware and purchased independently, the contractor shall provide the software license registered to the customer's organization.

5.9 Customer Support

The prime contractor shall provide 24x7 live telephone support during the warranty period to assist in isolating, identifying, and repairing software and hardware failures, or to act as liaison with the manufacturer in the event that the customer requires assistance in contacting or dealing with the manufacturer.

5.10 Product Maintenance

The contractor shall provide associated maintenance and upgrades to include spares/parts and emergency support worldwide, during the warranty period.

6. Delivery Requirements

6.1 Timeframes

Information Technology orders will be rated under the Defense Priorities and Allocation System (DPAS) with timelines identified during the award process. Title 15 [Code of Federal Regulations \(CFR\) Part 700](#) is administered by the Department of Commerce, Bureau of Industry and Security. DPAS implements the priorities and allocations authority of the Defense Production Act, including use of that authority to support emergency preparedness activities pursuant to Title VI of the Robert T. Stafford Disaster Relief and Emergency Assistance Act ([42 U.S.C. 5195 et seq.](#)), and the priorities authority of the Selective Service Act and related statutes, all with respect to industrial resources. The DPAS establishes procedures for the placement, acceptance, and performance of priority rated contracts and orders and for the allocation of materials, services, and facilities.

6.2 DO Order Shipping Date

This will be a DPAS DO-A7 rated order.

6.3 Delivery Delays

Contractors are required to meet the timeframes as stated in section 6.1 unless Department of Commerce approval and/or review activities prevent the contractor from meeting these timeframes. If the contractor determines they are unable to achieve the stated timeframes, the contractor shall notify the Contracting Officer within two (2) business days of such determination, or immediately upon such determination if operating under the Emergency/War Tempo timelines.

6.4 Shipping Information. All products shall be shipped to:

AFTAC BECO
1020 S. Patrick Drive, Bldg. 10989
Patrick SFB, FL 32925-3516

6.5 Inspection/Acceptance. The following Government officials are responsible for receiving the products and performing inspection:

Technical POC: Mr. Keith Mills